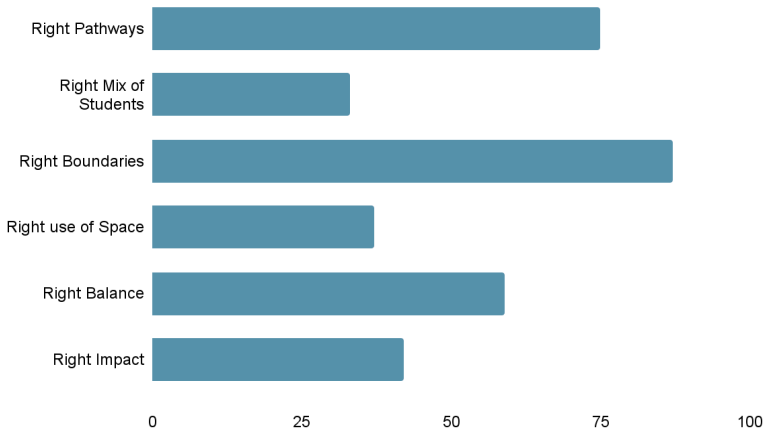
Board Engagement Summary at Kellogg Middle School
April 11, 2026

Between 84-164 respondents answered each Slido question during the engagement session held at Kellogg Middle School on April 11. While over 40 school communities were represented, Creston Elementary School, Lee Elementary School, and Chief Joseph Elementary were the most widely represented schools at this engagement session, and approximately 85% of participants were part of a K-5 school community., 4% identified as African American/Black, 3% identified as Asian, 3% identified as Middle Eastern/North African, 2% identified as American Indian/Alaska Native, 78% of participants identified as white, 8% as Hispanic/Latinx, 9% identified as multiracial. Nearly a third of participants had students in focus options. A quarter of families experienced a boundary change in the last five years.

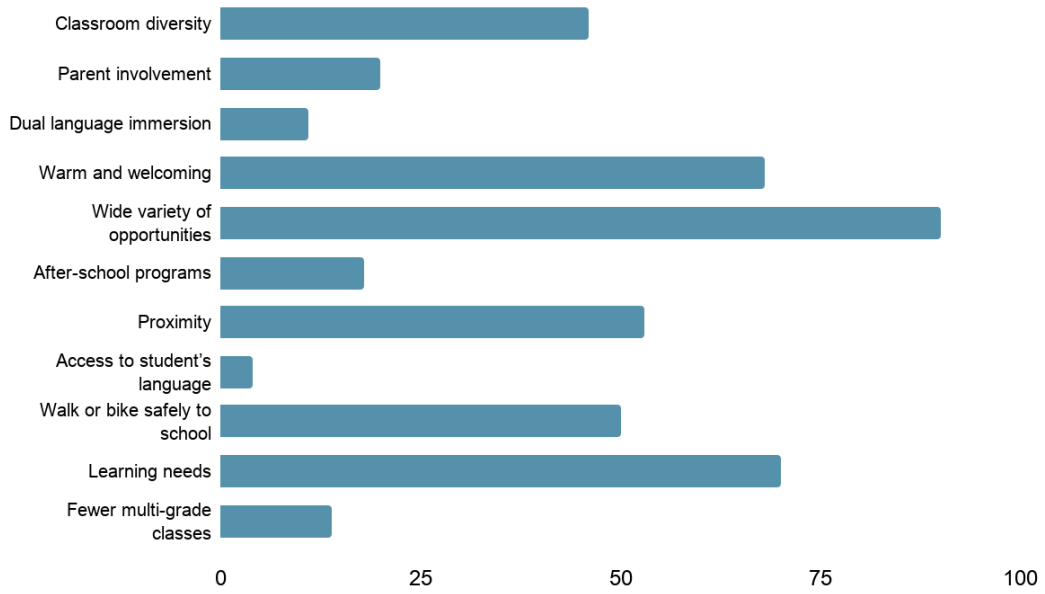
Of the six factors in the PPS student assignment policy, respondents prioritized compact boundaries, right pathways, and program balance more frequently than they prioritized impact, school demographics, and optimal use of facilities. (See Chart 1 for a breakdown of responses to this question).

Chart 1:
Responses to the question, "Our Portland Public Schools Student Assignment Policy asks us to consider the following six factors. Please select the three most important factors to consider during program and enrollment balancing across our system." (111 responses)



When asked to rank four factors that make a positive school environment, respondents identified a wide variety of learning opportunities, a warm and welcoming environment, access to services that meet all students' learning needs, and school diversity over ability of children who live close together to attend the same schools and ability to walk/bike to school. (See Chart 2 for a breakdown of responses to this question).

Chart 2:
Responses to the question, "select the top four factors that you think make a positive school environment" (111 responses)



When asked what helped students feel connected as they move from one school to the next, 84 participants said they feel most connected during school transitions when they can stay with neighborhood friends and established peer cohorts. Additionally, frequent turnover in school leadership can cause significant stress. Ultimately, a successful move is supported by geographic proximity and intentional transition efforts, such as early school visits, neighborhood-based activities, and strong parent-teacher involvement that fosters a sense of belonging before the first day of school.

If families reported choosing to change schools in the last five years (88), they did so primarily for specific academic programs like arts-integrated programs, STEM tracks, or language immersion. Many also moved out of necessity, seeking increased support for special needs or more manageable classroom environments when they felt their previous school lacked the resources to ensure physical and emotional safety. Beyond academics, transitions were driven by practical life changes, including neighborhood moves for housing affordability, a desire for shorter commutes, or a shift from private to public education for financial reasons and stronger local community ties.

Finally, respondents were asked what else leaders should know about this process. There is a strong demand for an equity-centered approach that prioritizes Title 1 schools, which provide essential social services, food pantries, and Migra Watch programs for migrant families.

Community members also expressed concern that consolidation will destroy the social and academic safety nets provided by neighborhood schools. Stakeholders emphasize that schools like Creston, Chief Joseph, Lent, and Buckman serve as vital community hubs, and that closing them would damage social cohesion. Families also warned that constant threat of school change is upending and mentally taxing, which drives families toward private or charter schools.

Finally, a major point of frustration is the lack of diverse representation in the decision-making process. Many noted that district meetings are often dominated by loudest voices (typically white, affluent parents), while working-class, non-English speaking, and marginalized families are unable to attend. Participants offered the recommendation that district leaders go directly to the school buildings to hear from those most impacted.